



TEACHING PLAN

Course Title:	Critical Thinking		
Course Code:	BES – 103		
Credit Hours:	3		
Contact Hours:	3 hours lecture per week		
Semester:	Semester 4		
Prerequisite(s):	None		
Instructor(s):	Hadiqua Fazal		
Course Website:	LMS		
Objectives:	The main course objectives are: -To enable students to apply the general principles of logic that make patterns of argument valid or invalid. -To develop an in-depth understanding of the concept and process of critical thinking.		
Course Learning Outcomes	After successful completion of this course, the students should be able to:	PLO	BT Level
	1. Demonstrate an increased ability to explain an issue or problem comprehensively	1	C2
	2. Analyse and comprehend an issue/problem by applying appropriate solutions based on their learnt methods and phenomena.	3	C4
	3. Develop an enhanced ability to draw logical conclusions and implications from the analysis of an issue or problem.	4	C3
Synopsis:	Teaching and learning approaches should foster a sense of understanding and respect, and sensitize students with emotions and feelings of tolerance towards others. Critical Thinking help students develop the habits of assessing and defending the reasonableness of our beliefs and values and those of others. Students are also engaged in project work, group discussions on articles from the newspapers and magazines that depict moral issues and problems. Attempt is also made to help students identify, evaluate and construct inductive and		



deductive arguments in spoken and written forms. Recognize common fallacies in every day reasoning Distinguish the kinds and purposes of definitions. Distinguish the functions of language and its capacity to express and influence meaning and Recognize and assess arguments in various forms of reasoning.

TENTATIVE COURSE SCHEDULE:

WEEK	TOPICS/SUBTOPICS	QUIZZES/ASSIGNMENTS	REMARKS
01	What is Critical Thinking • Why develop critical thinking skills • Benefits and Pitfalls of non-critical thinking		
02	Why develop Critical Thinking skills • Reasoning • Ancillary skills • Underlying skills and development • Self-awareness for accurate judgment. • Personal strategies for CT		
03	Critical thinking barriers		



04	Developing Thinking Skills • Assessing thinking skills • Detecting Emotional Manipulation • Focusing Attention • Identifying Difference • Recognizing Sequence • Categorizing	Quiz 1 Assignment 1	
05	Identifying/ Recognizing/ Evaluating Arguments • Author's Position • Persuasion through reason • Pinpointing Issues		
06	Activity in class Presenting and defending an argument	Quiz2	
07	Arguments/Non-Arguments • Arguments and Disagreements • Description • Explanation Distinguishing Arguments from other Material	Assignment2	
08	Mid Term Exam		
09	Step by Step Analysis of Arguments • Pinpointing Issues • Identifying Arguments • Seeking Clarity		



	• Understanding Context • Finding Credibility • Looking for Consistency • Judging Arguments Assignment for HW		
10	Implicit arguments • Identify Assumptions • Identifying hidden Assumptions • Implicit assumptions used as reasons		
11	Implicit arguments • Identify Assumptions • Identifying hidden Assumptions • Implicit assumptions used as reasons		
12	Implicit Arguments • False premises. • Why use implicit arguments • Denoted and connoted meanings • Stereotyping/ Latent messages	Quiz3	
13	Flaws in the arguments • Assuming Casual Link • Correlations and false correlations		
14	Not meeting the necessary conditions • Not meeting sufficient conditions • False Analogies • Deflective language	Quiz 4	
15	Recognizing Deceptive Reasoning	Assignmnet3	



16	Styles of Critical Thinkers and Non-Critical Thinkers.		
17	Problem Solving		
18	Final-Term Exam		

COURSE EVALUATION:

Type of Assessment	Percentage (%)	Remarks
Quizzes & Assignments	30	4 Quizzes (10 Marks) 3 Assignments (20 Marks)
Mid-Term Exam	20	
Final Exam	50	

TEXTBOOKS:

Main	Skills for Success, Personal Development and Employability by Dr.Stella Cottrell.
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Reference	1. Critical Thinking for students, Learn the Skills of Critical Skills and Effective Argument by Royvan- Den 3rd Edition. 2. Bassham, G, Irwin., Nardone, H, Wallace, J. Critical thinking: A Student's Introduction. New York: McGraw-Hill, 2011 3. Ruggiero, R, V. Beyond Feelings: A Guide to Critical Thinking. New York: McGraw-Hill, 2012.
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GRADING SCHEME:

Grade	Grade Point	LL %	UL %
A	4.00	≥ 85	-
A-	3.67	≥ 80	< 85
B+	3.33	≥ 75	< 80
B	3.00	≥ 71	< 75
B-	2.67	≥ 68	< 71
C+	2.33	≥ 64	< 68
C	2.00	≥ 60	< 64
C-	1.67	≥ 57	< 60
D+	1.33	≥ 53	< 57
D	1.00	≥ 50	< 53
F	0.00	-	< 50
W	Withdrawn		



COURSE POLICY:

Assignments	☐ Homework's are due at the beginning of class, ☐ Late homework's will not be accepted, ☐ All works must be done independently, ☐ Students handing in similar homework will receive a grade of 0 (ZERO) and face possible disciplinary actions.
Makeup Exams	In accordance with university regulations, i.e. students should bring a valid excuse authenticated through valid channels immediately within the first week after the exam. Otherwise, they will be considered absent and no makeup exam for them.
Attendance	☐ Students are expected to attend all classes ☐ Attendance is compulsory and will be taken regularly. ☐ Attendance for less than 80% of the lectures will result in students being barred from taking the Final Exam.
Code of Conduct	The assignments, quizzes, and exams need to be done individually. Copying of another student's work or code, even if changes are subsequently made, is inappropriate, and such work or code will not be accepted . The University has very clear guidelines for academic misconduct, and they will be enforced in this class.
Cell Phone	Cell phones are restricted during class. Cell phones must be turned off during the lecture. If your cell phone rings during class, you may be asked to leave.

**It is acknowledged that the objectives, synopsis of the course and distributions of examination marks will not be changed in the framework of the course as certified.*

Hadiqua Fazal _____

12 Feb 2025

Signature of Lecturer

Validated by Head of Department